

Kevin Grieco

✉ kevin.grieco@tse-fr.eu | 🌐 kevingrieco.net | 📞 +1 (508) 246-1698

Academic Position	Institute for Advanced Study in Toulouse, Research Fellow, 2025–present
Education	<i>PhD, Political Science, UCLA, 2024</i> Committee: Daniel Posner (co-chair), Darin Christensen (co-chair), Kate Baldwin, Cesi Cruz Predoctoral Fellow, International Centre for Tax and Development, 2024 <i>MS, International Development, Wageningen University, 2016</i> Specialization: Development Economics, <i>Cum Laude</i> <i>BA, Economics & Philosophy, University of New Hampshire, 2012</i>
Working Papers	“Building Fiscal Capacity with Traditional Authorities: Evidence from a Field Experiment and Interviews in Sierra Leone.” Job Market Paper. – R&R: <i>Political Science Research and Methods</i> “Participation, Legitimacy and Fiscal Capacity in Weak States: Evidence from Participatory Budgeting,” with Abou Bakarr Kamara, Niccolò Meriggi, Julian Michel, and Wilson Prichard. – Under review “Increasing Local Disease Preparedness and Surveillance Capacity for Global Health Security: A Cluster-Randomised Controlled Trial,” with Maarten Voors, Macartan Humphreys, Salif Jaiteh, Mohamed Alpha Jalloh, Sellu Kallon, Niccolò Meriggi, and Peter Van der Windt.
In Preparation	“Property Taxation and Political Accountability: Evidence from a Rule-Based Expansion of Tax Demands in Sierra Leone,” with Niccolò Meriggi, Julian Michel, and Wilson Prichard. “State-Building and the Social Contract in Dual Polities: Evidence from Sierra Leone,” with Vanessa van den Boogaard. “Business First: The Fiscal Contract in Weak States,” with Niccolò Meriggi, Julian Michel, and Wilson Prichard. “Mobilizing Voters with SMS in Sierra Leone,” with Niccolò Meriggi and Maarten Voors.
Ongoing Projects	“Credit Access for Responsible Extraction: Providing Incentives to Address Exploitation and Externalities in Sierra Leone’s Artisanal Mining Sector,” with Darin Christensen, Guy Grossman, and Cecilia Mo. “Preserving Mangroves and Livelihoods in Benin,” with Darin Christensen and Ambaliou Olounlade.
External Grants / Fellowships	Total to date: \$1,300,356 2025. Center for Governance and Markets, \$5,000. For <i>Explaining Governance Quality in Traditional Political Institutions: A Comparative Study in Sierra Leone</i> 2025. IGC, \$7,500. For <i>Exploring the Socio-Economic Causes and Consequences of ‘Kush’ Abuse Among Young People in Freetown, Sierra Leone</i>, with H. Mondeh 2024. J-PAL (K-CAI), \$57,860. For <i>Preserving Mangroves and Livelihoods in Benin</i>, with D. Christensen and A. Olounlade 2024. ICTD, \$194,000. For <i>Traditional Leaders and Formal and Informal Taxation in Sierra Leone</i>, with V. van den Boogaard

2022. Mercatus Center Frédéric Bastiat Fellowship (declined), **\$5,000**. For *Can Traditional Political Institutions Help the State Raise Property Taxes?*

2021. ICTD, **\$22,917**. For *Can Traditional Political Institutions Help the State Raise Property Taxes?*

2021. ICTD, **\$5,884**. For *Can Rural Property Taxation Generate Revenue?*

2021. C. Lowell Harriss Dissertation Fellowship, **\$10,000**.

2019. ICTD, **\$257,802**. For *Compliance, Accountability and the Social Contract*, with N. Meriggi, J. Michel, W. Prichard

2019. IGC, **\$25,929**. For *Taxation and Political Participation*, with D. Christensen

2019. IGC, **\$25,652**. For *Improving Tax Compliance in Freetown*, with D. Holliday and J. Michel

2018. IGC, **\$110,523**. For *Electrifying Growth*, with N. Meriggi, M. Mobarak, and M. Voors

2018. UKaid, **\$489,688**. For *Electrifying Growth*, with N. Meriggi, M. Mobarak, and M. Voors

2018. IGC, **\$25,542**. For *Improving Tax Systems in Sierra Leone*

2018. IGC, **\$10,994**. For *Electoral Impacts of Aid*, with N. Meriggi and M. Voors

2018. IGC, **\$28,165**. For *Mobilizing Voters with SMS*, with N. Meriggi and M. Voors

2018. IGC, **\$12,925**. For *Brighter Communities Safer Cities*, with D. Posner

2018. Sustainable Energy Transitions, **\$4,975**. For *Brighter Communities Safer Cities*

Internal Grants / Fellowships

2024. UCLA Political Science Department's Swarr Prize
– Best unpublished graduate student paper

2023. UCLA/Keck Humanistic Inquiry Graduate Research Award, **\$8,000**.

2023. UCLA Fellowship in Political Psychology, **\$1,995**.

2022. UCLA Dissertation Year Fellowship, **\$20,000**.

2022. UCLA Fellowship in Political Psychology, **\$2,000**.

2021. UCLA Summer Mentored Research Fellowship, **\$6,000**.

2021. UCLA Fellowship in Political Psychology, **\$2,000**.

2019. UCLA Graduate Summer Research Mentorship Award, **\$6,000**.

2018. UCLA Graduate Summer Research Mentorship Award, **\$6,000**.

Consulting & Policy Work

International Growth Centre, *Lead Researcher*, March 2025–November 2025
Project: [Sierra Leone's Kush crisis](#)

World Bank, *Lead Consultant*, May 2024–March 2025
Project: [Qualitative Assessment for Institutionalizing the Wan Fambul Framework in Sierra Leone](#)

ICTD, *Lead Consultant*, March 2021–November 2023
Project: [Can Rural Property Taxation Generate Revenue?](#)

Oxford Policy Management, *Lead Consultant*, June–July 2020
Project: [The Role of Traditional Leaders in COVID-19](#)

Oxford Policy Management, *Consultant*, March 2020–May 2020
Project: [A Rapid Assessment of the Response to COVID-19 in Sierra Leone](#)

Talks & Conferences

2026: EPSS; LSE-NYU Political Economy Conference; ECPR (Innsbruck)

2025: EuroWEPS 12; German Development Economics Conference; EPSA

2024: GLD Workshop (online); WGAP (Accra); World Bank Land Conference; IIPF; APCG Online Colloquium; Public Finance in Developing Countries; CGU Talk Series; UN-Habitat

2023: Governance and Local Development Institute Annual Conference

2022: CaliWEPS V; APSA; Global Development Conference; Sierra Leone Tax Conference
 2019: Harvard Experimental Political Science Graduate Conference

Service	Referee: <i>Comparative Political Studies</i> (×2); <i>International Tax and Public Finance</i> ; <i>Political Research Exchange</i> ; <i>Journal of Experimental Political Science</i> ; <i>Cogent Economics & Finance</i>	
	Organizer: IAST Conference on Migration, TSE	May 2026
	Organizer: Pieces of the Craft Workshop Series, UCLA	2018–2019
	Convener: Comparative Politics Reading Group, UCLA	2018–2019
Teaching	<i>Teaching Assistant, UCLA</i>	
	Introduction to Comparative Politics (undergraduate)	2018, 2021, 2023
	Foundations and Debates in Public Thought (undergraduate)	2022
	<i>Guest Lecturer</i>	
	Public Finance in Developing Countries, University of Oxford (graduate)	March 2024
Skills/ Experience	<i>Languages:</i> English (Native), Sierra Leone Krio (Intermediate), Spanish (Intermediate)	
	<i>Fieldwork:</i> Sierra Leone (4+ years); Benin	
	<i>Research Director:</i> Baobab, data-collection NGO registered in Freetown, Sierra Leone	
References	Kristin Michelitch	
	Associate Professor of Political Science	Toulouse School of Economics ✉ kristin.michelitch@iast.fr
	Daniel N. Posner	
	Professor of Political Science	University of California, Los Angeles ✉ dposner@polisci.ucla.edu
	Darin Christensen	
	Associate Professor of Public Policy & Political Science	University of California, Los Angeles ✉ darinc@luskin.ucla.edu
	Kate Baldwin	
	Associate Professor of Political Science & Global Affairs	Yale University ✉ kate.baldwin@yale.edu